members and a few part time members who were of cabinet rank. The full time members were persons who have excelled in the technical field, economy and administration. The Prime Minister is the chairman of the Planning Commission enabling the coordination of the functions of the Commission.

As per the recommendations of the Administrative Reforms Commission changes were made in the composition of the Commission. It included the Prime Minister as the Chairman who presides over the meetings of the Commission, a deputy chairman who is the de-facto executive head and who has the responsibility of formulating the drafts of the plan to the central cabinet, a secretary, four full time members and some cabinet ministers as part-time members. The Finance Minister and Planning Minister are ex-officio members of the Commission and a member secretary who is usually a senior IAS officer are also part of the Commission. The functioning of the administration was coordinated by the additional secretary. Senior officers in the ranks of deputy secretaries and under secretaries had to monitor the progress of the programmes. There were no representatives from the state government and it was a central body.

The Planning Commission of India worked on the principle of collective responsibility. It had three organs namely the General Division, Subject Division and the Administrative Division. The General Division relates to the entire economy and Subject Divisions concerns with specific areas of development like food and agriculture, power and irrigation, transportation etc. The Commission also includes the General administration branch and Evaluation Divisions.

Along with these, various other bodies also worked with the Planning Commission for the formulation and execution of plans. They are;-

i) National Planning Council

The National Planning Council was constituted during the Fourth Plan in 1965. It consisted of experts in science, engineering and economics and worked on areas that include agriculture, land reforms, irrigation, education, employment, industry, trade, management, family planning, social welfare, natural resources, transport and international trade. It was the responsibility of each of these groups to study in detail the needs of each of the areas and give the data to the Planning Commission.

ii) National Development Council (NDC)

The National Development Council included all the Chief Ministers of the States along with the Prime Minister as its chairman. The inclusion of the states enables the implementation of the plans in the respective states. Some cabinet ministers of the central government could also be present during the deliberations of the NDC. The NDC had the role of reviewing the implementation of the plans periodically and discusses various issues relating to the development of the state. It makes recommendations for the effective implementation of plans and also ensures involvement and support of the people in plan implementation. It works for effective administrative services and aims at developing resources that are essential for future development.

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